

Croatia

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** December 22, 1990 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red, white, and blue are traditional Croatian colors



The tricolor charged with the coat of arms was first used during World War II

Arms of Croatia

Europe



For much of its existence, **Croatia** was under Austrian rule. It joined Yugoslavia in 1919, but declared independence on June 25, 1991.

While part of Yugoslavia, Croatia's flag was designed in the pan-Slavic colors, red, white, and blue. These are also traditional Croatian colors used in the 19th century.

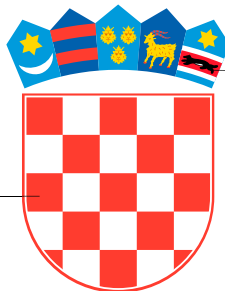
During World War II Croatia became a semi-independent state and added the arms of Croatia to the center of its flag. Following the war,

Croatia retained its tricolor but a gold-edged red star was placed in the center by Tito. Before gaining independence, the present flag was adopted, based on the one used during the war.

The shield is in the red and white checks of Croatia. Above is a row of shields of its various territories.

ARMS OF CROATIA

The red and white checks are traditional emblems of Croatia



The small shields at the top are taken from the arms of Croatia's regions. From left to right the ancient arms of Croatia, Dubrovnik, Dalmatia, Istria, and Slavonia